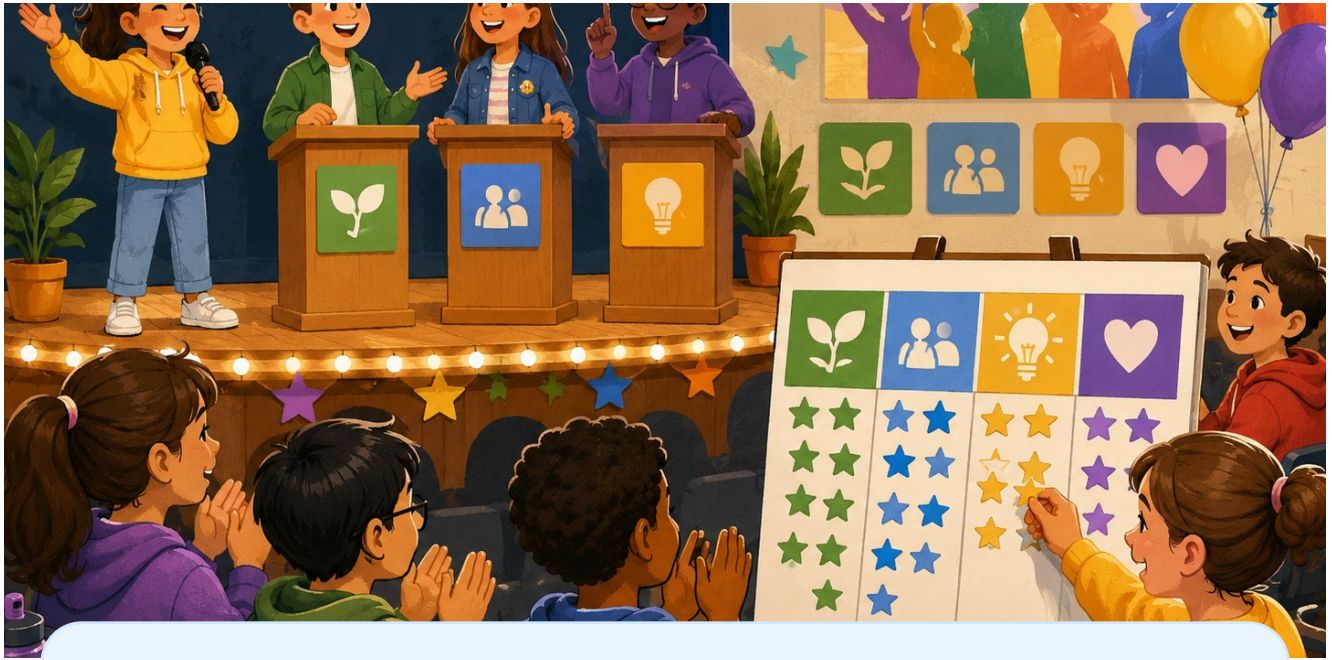




Mini Debate Worksheet

DAY 13 - Ages 8-12 - Speaking & Listening

Name: _____

Date: _____

Team: _____

Today I can...

Share

I can say my opinion: I think...

Reason

I can explain: because...

Listen

I can ask: Can you explain?

Respect

I can say: Good point!

Class promise: We think. We listen. We explain. We respect.

A good debate is not a fight. A good debate helps every student speak and listen.



1. Warm-up: Choose Your Side

02

Circle your opinion. Then tell a partner one simple reason.

Say it: I agree because _____. / I disagree because _____. / Maybe, but _____.

Topic 1

Dogs are the best pets.

☐ I agree

☐ I disagree

Topic 2

Homework is helpful.

☐ I agree

☐ I disagree

Topic 3

Fruit is better than candy.

☐ I agree

☐ I disagree

Topic 4

Books are better than TV.

☐ I agree

☐ I disagree

Topic 5

Outdoor play is best.

☐ I agree

☐ I disagree

Topic 6

Music helps students learn.

☐ I agree

☐ I disagree

My best quick reason:

I think _____ because _____.

Partner says: _____



2. Debate Words

03

Draw lines to match each word to its meaning. Then use the words in sentences.

WORDS

1. opinion

2. agree

3. disagree

4. reason

5. example

6. because

7. maybe

8. respect

MEANINGS

A. kind words for others

B. why you think it

C. not sure yet

D. what you think

E. same idea

F. one real thing

G. starts a reason

H. different idea

Fill in the blanks:

1. My _____ is: games are fun.
2. I agree _____ exercise is good.
3. I can _____ my friend by listening.
4. Can you give one _____?



3. Phrase Builder

04

Complete the sentence starters. Practice the dialogue with a partner.

A. Finish the debate phrases.

I think _____.

because _____.

I agree because _____.

I disagree because _____.

Maybe, but _____.

B. Mini dialogue practice

A What do you think?

B I think _____.

A Why?

B Because _____.

A I agree / disagree because _____.

B Good point! Can you explain more?

A Yes. Another reason is _____.

Challenge: Change the topic and practice again.



4. Listening: The Mini Debate

05

Listen to your teacher. Fill the table and answer with 1, 2, or 3.

A. Listen and fill the table.

Name	Opinion	Reason	Agree/Disagree
Leo			
Maya			
Jay			

B. Listening check. Circle 1, 2, or 3.

1. What is the question?

☐

1 best pet

☐

2 best color

☐

3 fastest animal

2. Who thinks dogs are better?

☐

1 Leo

☐

2 Maya

☐

3 the teacher

3. Why does Leo like dogs?

☐

1 they can play

☐

2 they can fly

☐

3 they are purple

4. What does Maya say about cats?

☐

1 cats are quiet

☐

2 cats are loud

☐

3 cats are big

C. Write one sentence you heard.



5. Mingle Survey: Find Opinions

06

Ask four classmates. Write short answers. Use English first.

Ask: What do you think? Then ask: Why? Then ask: Do you agree or disagree?

Answer: I think _____. Because _____. / I agree. / I disagree.

Topic choices: pets, school, food, free time, games, outside, music, art.

Name	Topic	Opinion	Reason	A/D

After listening:

One classmate changed my thinking: _____ because _____.

A kind phrase I used: Good point! / I understand. / Thank you.



6. Mini Debate Planner

07

Choose a topic. Prepare your side with reasons and examples.

A. Choose one debate topic.

☐ Pets: Dogs are the best pets.

☐ School: Homework is helpful.

☐ Food: Fruit is better than candy.

☐ Free Time: Books are better than TV.

B. My side

☐ I agree

☐ I disagree

My opinion: I think _____.

C. Reasons and examples

Reason 1

Because _____

Example: _____

Helpful word: _____

Reason 2

Because _____

Example: _____

Helpful word: _____

D. Team roles and speaking order

Moderator	Speaker A	Speaker B	Reason Keeper	Reporter
Name:				
Line:				



7. Speak, Listen, Reflect

08

Use this page during and after your mini debate.

A. Mini debate script

Moderator: Our topic is _____. What do you think?

Speaker A: I think _____ because _____.

Speaker B: I agree / disagree because _____.

Speaker A: Can you explain?

Speaker B: Yes. For example, _____.

Reason Keeper: I heard the word because _____ times.

Reporter: Our team thinks _____. Thank you.

B. Peer checklist

☐ Everyone spoke once.

☐ We used I think.

☐ We used because.

☐ We listened kindly.

☐ We said Good point.

Team score: ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

C. Speaking Passport: Day 13 Stamp

☐ share an opinion - I think...

☐ give a reason - because...

☐ ask a question - Why?

☐ respect a friend - Good point!

Circle one: I can do it / I need practice / I need help



Listening script: The Mini Debate

Teacher: Here is the question. Which pet is better, dogs or cats? Leo: I think dogs are better pets. Dogs can play, and they can run with us. Maya: I disagree because cats are quiet. Cats are easy to care for. Jay: Good point. I agree with Leo because dogs are friendly, but cats are good too. Teacher: Thank you. You listened and gave reasons.

Tip: Read twice. First time, students only listen. Second time, students fill the table.

Quick answer key

Page 3 matching: opinion-D, agree-E, disagree-H, reason-B, example-F, because-G, maybe-C, respect-A.

Page 3 fill: opinion; because; respect; reason/example.

Page 5 table: Leo-dogs-can play/runs with us-agree; Maya-cats-cats are quiet/easy to care for-disagree; Jay-dogs-dogs are friendly-agree.

Page 5 multiple choice: 1-1, 2-1, 3-1, 4-1.

Mini rubric

Skill	1 - support	2 - developing	3 - ready
Opinion	needs model	says I think	says clear opinion
Reason	uses one word	uses because	because + example
Respect	needs reminder	listens	responds kindly